

Allusion — Venue Rental Platform

Workflows & Use Cases — Executive Overview

The Story Behind This

Allusion has a building with a room that sits empty most of the time. The team uses it once a week and occasionally during lunch breaks, but for the large majority of the week it is unused. Rather than leaving that space idle, Allusion wants to rent it out during those empty hours and days — generating income from an asset they already own, without creating extra work for the team.

The immediate goal is simple and binary: rent the space at least once a month. Either it happens or it does not. That is the measure of success for this project.

The challenge is doing this in a way that does not become a burden. Nobody at Allusion wants to become an event manager. The system should be so well automated that the team's involvement is reduced to a single brief moment: reading an incoming request and deciding yes or no. Everything else — communication, invoicing, payments, calendar management, reminders, and access coordination — runs on its own.

A key principle agreed upon is that the automation must feel human. The system should not feel like a cold bot, but should communicate in a natural, professional way — as if a person were handling it.

Giovanni's role in particular is worth highlighting. His strength is his network. When he is at an event in Brussels or talking to someone who might need a space, his only job is to share a link. From that moment on, the system takes over completely. He should never have to write an invoice, follow up on a payment, or coordinate access. That is exactly what this platform is designed to prevent.

Page 1 — Use Cases

1. A customer wants to rent the room for a day or more A customer finds our booking page, fills in a short form explaining what they need the room for, selects their dates and times, and submits. The system checks availability automatically. If the dates are free, Allusion receives a notification with all the details. The team reviews it briefly — this takes no more than a few minutes — and either approves or declines. From that point on, everything is handled automatically.

2. A customer wants to rent the room for a specific event or purpose Same flow as above. Because the purpose of the rental matters to Allusion, the customer is asked to briefly explain their reason when submitting the form. This gives Allusion the context needed to make a quick and informed decision at the approval step. No meeting is needed in most cases.

3. Allusion wants to have a quick conversation before approving For bookings that feel unusual or require more context, Allusion has the option to request a short meeting with the customer before deciding. This meeting is scheduled automatically and added to both parties' calendars. After the meeting, Allusion approves or declines as normal.

4. A customer wants to visit the space before committing If a customer asks to see the room first, they can request a visit through the same form. The visit is scheduled automatically, and the customer receives a calendar invite. After the visit, the booking process continues normally if they wish to proceed.

5. A customer does not pay after approval If a customer is approved but does not complete payment within the agreed time, they receive automatic reminders. If they still do not pay, the booking is automatically cancelled, the dates are released, and Allusion is notified. No manual follow-up is needed from the team.

6. A customer cancels a confirmed booking If a customer cancels, the system processes it automatically according to Allusion's cancellation policy — sending a confirmation, handling any applicable refund, and making the room available again for new bookings.

7. A customer does not show up Once a booking is confirmed and paid, the responsibility lies entirely with the customer. If they do not show up, that is their own decision. Allusion has already been paid and no action is required from the team.

Page 2 — End-to-End Workflow

This is the full journey of every booking from first contact to completion. Steps marked with **[Allusion]** are the only moments where a human needs to be involved.

Step 1 — Customer submits a request The customer fills in the online booking form: their name, contact details, the dates they want, the purpose of the rental, and the number of people attending. Submission takes under two minutes.

Step 2 — Availability is checked automatically The system immediately confirms whether the requested dates are free. If not, the customer is informed automatically and offered the next available slot.

Step 3 — Allusion is notified (*automated*) The responsible person at Allusion receives a clear, structured notification with everything they need to make a decision: who is requesting, what for, how many people, and for how long.

Step 4 — Allusion reviews and decides **[Allusion]** This is the first and most important human step. The team reads the request and either approves it, declines it, or requests a brief meeting. This takes a few minutes at most.

Step 5 — Optional: a meeting is scheduled (*automated if triggered*) If Allusion wants to speak with the customer first, a calendar invite is sent automatically to both sides. After the meeting, Allusion returns to step 4.

Step 6 — Customer is notified of the outcome (*automated*) If declined, the customer receives a polite message explaining the decision. If approved, they move to the payment step.

Step 7 — Invoice is generated and sent (*automated*) An invoice is created automatically and sent to the customer with a secure online payment link. No manual invoice writing is needed.

Step 8 — Customer pays (*customer action*) The customer pays by card through the payment link. Until payment is completed, the booking is not confirmed and no access is granted.

Step 9 — Confirmation is sent automatically (*automated*) The moment payment is received, the customer gets a confirmation email and a calendar invite — compatible with Google Calendar, Apple Calendar, or any other standard calendar app — with all the details: date, time, address, access instructions, and any relevant house rules. Allusion receives the same invite in their own calendar so the booking is always visible to the team.

Step 10 — Internal tasks are assigned (*automated*) The person at Allusion responsible for access or preparation receives an automatic notification with the booking details and what they need to do before the rental date.

Step 11 — Reminders are sent (*automated*) The customer receives a reminder 3 days before and again the day before. The operations contact at Allusion also receives a reminder to ensure everything is ready.

Step 12 — Day of the rental **[Allusion — minimal]* The customer arrives at the agreed time and is given access to the room. This is the second and final moment where Allusion needs to be physically present — simply to open the door or hand over access.

Step 13 — After the rental (*automated*) The customer receives a short follow-up message. The booking is closed in the system and the room becomes available for new requests automatically.

Page 3 — Team Roles & Why This Works

Allusion's role in this system is to orchestrate, not to operate. The team approves requests, and the team receives guests. That is essentially the full extent of their involvement. The system is also designed to be proactive — meaning it takes initiative on its own rather than waiting for someone to trigger it. For example, after a completed rental, the system can automatically follow up, prepare communications, and flag anything that needs attention, without anyone having to ask it to do so.

For approvals, the team uses a shared Telegram or Slack group where incoming requests and any decisions that need a human eye are posted automatically. Team members can approve or flag something directly from their phone in seconds. The goal is to remove Gio, or any single person, as a bottleneck. No one should have to be the one who always initiates — the system initiates, and the team simply responds when needed.

Customer / Renter Submits a request online, pays if approved, and receives everything they need automatically. They do not need to call or email anyone. If they pay and show up on time, they get access. If they do not pay, they do not get in. If they do not show up, that is their responsibility.

Allusion Administrator The person who receives booking requests and makes the approval decision. This is a brief, occasional task — not a daily job. They also have a full overview of all upcoming and past bookings at any time.

Giovanni / Network Role Giovanni's value to this project is his network, not his time. His only action in this system is sharing a booking link when speaking to potential renters — at events, meetings, or casual conversations. The moment someone clicks that link and submits a request, the system takes over. Giovanni does not write invoices, coordinate access, or follow up on payments. The platform exists specifically so he never has to.

Finance Has no manual work to do in the day-to-day flow. Invoices are generated automatically and payments are collected online. However, for cancellations and refunds, Allusion is notified in a clear inbox or dashboard — showing exactly what happened, what the customer is owed if anything, and what action is needed. This keeps the finance person in control of money movements without being involved in every booking. The tools being considered for this are Odoo, which can handle invoicing and financial tracking in one place, and Stripe, which handles online payments and refunds reliably. The final choice between them — or a combination of both — will be decided based on what fits Allusion's workflow best.

Why This Approach

Allusion has a valuable space that generates nothing while it sits empty. With this system, that space becomes a source of income with almost no operational overhead. The team does not need to hire someone to manage bookings. They do not need to be available around the clock. They simply check a notification, make a quick decision, and the system handles the rest.

The tools used are modern, reliable, and widely used by businesses across Europe. For payments and invoicing, two strong options are being evaluated: **Stripe**, which is simple, widely trusted, and handles online payments and automatic refunds with minimal setup, and **Odoo**, which is a more complete business tool that can manage invoices, payments, and financial records all in one place. Both can be highly automated. The right choice — or a combination of both — will be confirmed once we have a clearer picture of how Allusion wants to handle its finances and what level of oversight they prefer.

This is not a complex IT project. It is a practical, lean solution that turns an empty room into a working business asset.

Document prepared for internal review — all workflows and responsibilities are subject to change based on feedback from the Allusion team.